



Senate

General Assembly

File No. 562

February Session, 2026

Substitute Senate Bill No. 385

Senate, April 9, 2026

The Committee on Government Administration and Elections reported through SEN. FLEXER of the 29th Dist., Chairperson of the Committee on the part of the Senate, that the substitute bill ought to pass.

AN ACT CONCERNING THE TITLING OF BILLS.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Section 2-56 of the general statutes is repealed and the
2 following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

3 (a) The legislative commissioners shall:

4 [(a)] (1) Collect and compare the laws of this and other states
5 pertaining to any subject upon which they are requested to report by the
6 Governor or any committee or member of the General Assembly;

7 [(b)] (2) Collect upon request of the General Assembly all available
8 information relating to any matter which is the subject of proposed
9 legislation by the General Assembly;

10 [(c)] (3) Prepare or advise in the preparation of any bill or resolution
11 when requested to do so by the Governor or any member of the General
12 Assembly;

13 [(d)] (4) Upon request of the Governor, advise the Governor
14 concerning any bill which has been passed by the General Assembly and
15 has been or is to be presented to the Governor for his approval or
16 disapproval;

17 [(e) Before any bill is favorably reported to either branch of the
18 General Assembly, either commissioner shall approve its form and note
19 his certification to such effect on such bill. If such commissioner
20 disapproves of the form of any bill submitted to him, he shall return
21 such bill to the committee from which it was received with his
22 disapproval and the reasons therefor noted thereon. Either
23 commissioner shall, on request of the member introducing an
24 amendment, examine the same as to form and return it to the member
25 with his approval, or with his disapproval with the reasons therefor
26 noted thereon. After all amendments to any bill have been adopted by
27 either house of the General Assembly before final passage, such bill and
28 the amendments shall be immediately turned over to either
29 commissioner by the clerk of such house. Such commissioner shall
30 examine such bill, as amended, as to its form, shall cause the amended
31 sections of it to be reprinted as amended, unless reprinting is waived by
32 the majority and minority leaders of such house, and shall return it to
33 such clerk with his approval or disapproval, with the reasons therefor,
34 noted thereon. If such bill, as amended, is disapproved as to form, such
35 clerk shall call such disapproval to the attention of the General
36 Assembly. If any bill is amended during the last five session days, it
37 shall be so submitted to either commissioner but the amended sections
38 of it need not be reprinted. This subsection shall not apply to any
39 amendment adopted solely for the correction of clerical errors or errors
40 as to form or dates, except that a copy of any such amendment shall be
41 immediately transmitted to either commissioner by the clerk of the
42 house in which it is first adopted;]

43 [(f)] (5) Render such research and advisory services to the Joint
44 Committee on Legislative Management as said committee requests; and

45 [(g)] (6) Consolidate and codify all the statutes and public acts of the

46 state, and arrange and codify the same under chapter and sections with
47 headnotes, annotations and references to original text and to any
48 decisions of the Supreme Court interpreting the same, and revise such
49 volumes thereof as have become obsolete by reason of the number of
50 amendments thereto or related legislation subsequently enacted. One
51 copy of such consolidation and codification and of each revised volume
52 shall be filed in the office of the Secretary of the State.

53 (b) The legislative commissioners shall choose an appropriate title for
54 all bills. In the case of a bill to be favorably reported by a committee of
55 the General Assembly, any member of the committee may object to the
56 title of the bill prior to a committee vote to favorably report the bill, and
57 if the member and the legislative commissioners cannot agree on the bill
58 title, the title shall be "An Act Concerning Matters Related To" followed
59 by the name of the committee of cognizance. In the case of a bill on the
60 calendar of either house of the General Assembly, any member of such
61 house may object to the title of the bill prior to voting on the bill, and if
62 the member and the legislative commissioners cannot agree on the bill
63 title, the title shall be "An Act Concerning Matters Related To" followed
64 by the name of the committee of cognizance.

65 (c) Before any bill is favorably reported to either house of the General
66 Assembly, either commissioner shall approve its form and note the
67 commissioner's certification to such effect on such bill. If such
68 commissioner disapproves of the form of any bill submitted to such
69 commissioner, the commissioner shall return such bill to the committee
70 from which it was received with the commissioner's disapproval and
71 the reasons therefor noted thereon. Either commissioner shall, on
72 request of the member introducing an amendment, examine the same as
73 to form and return it to the member with the commissioner's approval
74 or disapproval, and in the case of a disapproval, with the reasons
75 therefor noted thereon. After all amendments to any bill have been
76 adopted by either house of the General Assembly before final passage,
77 such bill and the amendments shall be immediately turned over to either
78 commissioner by the clerk of such house. Such commissioner shall
79 examine such bill, as amended, as to its form, shall cause the amended

80 sections of it to be reprinted as amended, unless reprinting is waived by
81 the majority and minority leaders of such house, and shall return it to
82 such clerk with the commissioner's approval or disapproval, with the
83 reasons therefor, noted thereon. If such bill, as amended, is disapproved
84 as to form, such clerk shall call such disapproval to the attention of the
85 General Assembly. If any bill is amended during the last five session
86 days, it shall be so submitted to either commissioner but the amended
87 sections of it need not be reprinted. This subsection shall not apply to
88 any amendment adopted solely for the correction of clerical errors or
89 errors as to form or dates, except that a copy of any such amendment
90 shall be immediately transmitted to either commissioner by the clerk of
91 the house in which it is first adopted.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:

Section 1	October 1, 2026	2-56
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GAE *Joint Favorable Subst.*

The following Fiscal Impact Statement and Bill Analysis are prepared for the benefit of the members of the General Assembly, solely for purposes of information, summarization and explanation and do not represent the intent of the General Assembly or either chamber thereof for any purpose. In general, fiscal impacts are based upon a variety of informational sources, including the analyst's professional knowledge. Whenever applicable, agency data is consulted as part of the analysis, however final products do not necessarily reflect an assessment from any specific department.

OFA Fiscal Note

State Impact: None

Municipal Impact: None

Explanation

The bill alters the process for the titling of bills and does not result in a fiscal impact to the state.

The Out Years

State Impact: None

Municipal Impact: None

OLR Bill Analysis**sSB 385*****AN ACT CONCERNING THE TITLING OF BILLS.*****SUMMARY**

This bill requires the legislative commissioners to choose an appropriate title for all bills. The bill authorizes a committee member, prior to a vote to favorably report a bill, and a member of either house, prior to voting on a bill on the calendar of either house, to object to the bill title. If the member and the legislative commissioners cannot agree on the bill title, the bill requires the title to be "An Act Concerning Matters Related To" followed by the name of the committee of cognizance.

It is unclear whether the bill's provisions apply to budget, deficiency, and other appropriations bills, which by law must have certain titles (see CGS § 2-34).

The bill also makes minor technical changes.

EFFECTIVE DATE: October 1, 2026

COMMITTEE ACTION

Government Administration and Elections Committee

Joint Favorable Substitute

Yea 19 Nay 0 (03/23/2026)